An autonomous recovery layer for paid customers missing access

Business plan · neatHack 2026 submission
Forecast: October 2026–September 2027 · Planning currency: USD
Prepared 11 October 2026

> **Current commercial position:** zero paying customers, $0 MRR, no commercial sales and no external funding. Confirmed unrestricted business cash: **$0 as of 11 October 2026**. The founder is currently unpaid.

Executive summary

Aftermath is an early-stage B2B SaaS product for a specific operational failure: a customer successfully pays, but the SaaS application fails to grant purchased access. Aftermath detects the mismatch, independently verifies payment, uses an AI agent to investigate, applies deterministic authorization checks, restores the missing entitlement and records an auditable execution trail.

The founder reports a functional, publicly deployed MVP developed for neatHack 2026 and a successful Paystack test-mode demonstration using Claude Sonnet 4.6. This is a meaningful technical proof of concept—not evidence of production reliability, customer demand or willingness to pay.

The initial commercialization hypothesis is to sell to SaaS operators using Paystack. Monthly subscription pricing is proposed at $49 Starter, $199 Growth and Enterprise from $599. The first task is to prove incident frequency, paid demand and safe integration economics with a small number of design partners before scaling spend.

Base-case planning result	October 2026–September 2027
Subscription revenue	$22,321
September expected customers / MRR	49.9 / $4,755
Operating profit before tax, excluding unpaid founder labor	$9,664
Peak operating cash shortfall	$1,377
Cash target including reserve and contingency	$2,734

Recommendation: remain founder-led, validate paid pilots and secure a small, explicit source of funding or customer prepayment before activating the proposed paid budget. Unpaid-founder operating profit is not proof of a fully compensated, sustainable business. The separate future-salary case makes that distinction visible.

All future customer counts, conversions, growth, churn and profits in this document are unvalidated model assumptions or calculated projections. Restoring an entitlement for an already-paid order is not newly generated revenue.

Problem, product and beachhead market

The failure Aftermath addresses

Payment confirmation and entitlement fulfillment are separate steps in a SaaS purchase. A missed webhook, application failure, inconsistent state or interrupted downstream operation can leave a paid customer without access. The proposed buyer problem is the effort and delay involved in diagnosing the discrepancy, verifying payment and safely repairing fulfillment. Incident causes and frequency are hypotheses to test with operators, not established market statistics.

The product workflow

- **Detect:** identify a successful payment without its expected entitlement.
- **Verify:** independently confirm the payment and relevant order evidence.
- **Investigate:** an AI agent explains the mismatch using the available evidence.
- **Authorize deterministically:** enforce non-AI safety checks before a state-changing action.
- **Recover and confirm:** restore only the missing authorized entitlement; retain the decision, execution and confirmation trail.

Current technology comprises Next.js, PostgreSQL on Neon, Railway, Paystack, Claude Sonnet 4.6 through a sponsored LiteLLM gateway, and neatlogs observability. Sponsored access and free tiers are temporary deployment benefits, not permanent commercial unit economics.

Initial target customer

The proposed beachhead is a small-to-mid-sized SaaS operator using Paystack, with recurring or digital-access sales, a clearly defined entitlement system and an engineering or support owner who handles payment discrepancies. The first buyer is likely a founder, engineering lead or operations/support lead. These are ICP hypotheses; there are no signed customer contracts or verified market-size claims in this plan.

Value and alternatives

Potential value is less manual investigation, shorter time to restore access, fewer support escalations and better auditability. Possible retention benefits must be measured rather than booked as revenue. Alternatives include retries/reconciliation scripts, manual support repair and in-house incident tooling. Aftermath’s proposed differentiation is the integrated evidence-to-recovery workflow with deterministic execution checks—not a claim that all alternatives lack safeguards.

Technical validation versus proof still required

Demonstrated / founder-reported	Not yet validated
Public MVP and one Paystack test-mode recovery	Production error rates, scale and security review
Claude investigation + independent evidence checks	Behavior under varied failure causes and adversarial inputs
Deterministic authorization + audit trail	Customer willingness to pay, retention and service-level commitments

Provider expansion is a later milestone, not a current capability or partnership claim. No independently verified production benchmark, security certification or legal incorporation status is asserted.

Pricing and commercialization

Unvalidated subscription hypotheses

Plan	Monthly price	Monitored transactions[1]	AI investigations[1]	Support workload[2]	Contribution / account[3]
Starter	$49	1,000	2	9 min	$42.51
Growth	$199	5,000	10	30 min	$175.18
Enterprise	$599+	20,000	40	120 min	$513.63

Starter: entry-level recovery for a simple Paystack integration. **Growth:** a larger monitored population and more investigation/support workload. **Enterprise:** custom scoping from $599; pricing must reflect integration complexity, audit requirements, support coverage and transaction/agent usage. No enterprise SLA or 24/7 support is promised by the MVP.

Usage limits: proposal, not validated entitlements

[1] For a judge-readable commercial offer, this plan proposes initial monthly included allowances aligned to the saved usage assumptions: 1,000 / 5,000 / 20,000 monitored transactions and 2 / 10 / 40 agent investigations. **The existing model uses these as expected usage, not enforced caps or a proven demand distribution.** The packaging is a submission proposal; it does not change model inputs, implement product limits or create overage revenue.

An investigation budget assumes 20,000 input tokens, 2,000 output tokens and a 1.5× retry/context multiplier across the workflow. Alert at approaching allowances; require an explicit upgrade or custom agreement before charging for additional usage. Maintain a safe manual escalation path rather than granting unauthorized access, silently charging, deleting evidence or abandoning a paid user’s incident. Enforce time, token and retry budgets separately from entitlement authorization.

[2] Support minutes are planning averages, not contracted response times or hard customer support limits.
[3] Contribution deducts inference, paid support, variable infrastructure and estimated collection fees; it excludes fixed delivery infrastructure, acquisition, founder/contractor costs and tax.

Route to the first sale

- Founder-led discovery and demonstrations to Paystack SaaS operators; no partnership with Paystack is assumed.
- Offer a narrowly scoped pilot: limited permissions, explicit recovery authorization, logs, escalation and revocation. Begin in observation/shadow mode before authorized production recovery.
- Ask operators to pay for reduced investigation workload and reliability. Test $49/$199 willingness to pay; do not substitute interview enthusiasm for a paid commitment.
- Use references and measured incident-resolution outcomes to earn expansion. No restored-order value, churn savings, setup fees or overage fees are included in forecast revenue.

Invoices are modeled monthly. Revenue follows average active accounts; MRR reflects month-end accounts. Base mix is 70% Starter, 30% Growth and 0% Enterprise. Enterprise adoption appears only in upside from April 2027.

Operating budget and model mechanics

> These are **proposed commercial paid costs**, not reported bills. Current free infrastructure and sponsored model credits are excluded from normalized cost projections; they are not treated as revenue.

Cost category	Saved-model basis	12-month base cost
AI inference	Usage × tokens × retry overhead	$141.23
Customer support	$25/hour; 0.15 / 0.5 / 2 hours per average account	$1,511.87
Variable infrastructure	$1 / $4 / $12 per average account/month	$451.14
Subscription collection fees	Estimated 3% of subscription revenue	$669.64
Hosting	$50/month	$600.00
Database	$25/month	$300.00
Monitoring	$25/month	$300.00
Customer acquisition	$200 in October; grows 5% each month	$3,183.43
Engineering contractor	Hypothetical $800/month, June–September	$3,200.00
Founder cash compensation	Confirmed $0; excluded in all three demand cases	$0.00
Tools	$50/month	$600.00
Administration	$100/month	$1,200.00
Launch setup	Proposed $500 once in October	$500.00

Total paid delivery cost: $3,973.88. **Total operating expenses:** $8,683.43. Combined proposed costs: $12,657.31. Delivery includes inference, support, variable infrastructure, collection fees and fixed hosting/database/monitoring. Contractor, acquisition, tools, admin and setup sit in operating expenses.

How the forecast works

- Base starts with a hypothetical 20 qualified prospects/month; prospects grow 10% monthly. Fifteen percent convert after one month. This is not a pipeline report.
- Expected additions follow plan mix. Monthly churn is 3% Starter, 2% Growth, 1% Enterprise; no expansion or annual billing is assumed.
- Ending accounts = opening accounts + additions − churn. Revenue = average active accounts × plan price, allowing half-month revenue for additions and losses.
- Collections equal monthly revenue with zero collection lag. Expenses are paid in their month. Cash flow therefore equals operating profit in this simplified model.

The proposed founder time budget is 20 sales hours/month; purchased support capacity is estimated at 40 hours/month. Benefits, taxes, incorporation costs, VAT treatment, FX, gateway markup, capex, debt, credit losses and contractual liabilities remain unquantified. Nigeria is confirmed; legal and tax obligations are not confirmed. Zero modeled tax is not a tax exemption.

Monthly revenue and operating forecast

Base case, October 2026–September 2027. All amounts USD. Customer counts are probability-weighted expected populations, not actual named accounts. Today: zero paying customers and zero MRR.

Month	Ending accounts	MRR	Revenue	Gross profit	Operating profit/(loss)
Oct 2026	0.0	$0	$0	($100)	($950)
Nov 2026	3.0	$282	$141	$23	($337)
Dec 2026	6.2	$586	$434	$280	($91)
Jan 2027	9.7	$913	$749	$556	$175
Feb 2027	13.4	$1,267	$1,090	$854	$461
Mar 2027	17.4	$1,650	$1,458	$1,177	$772
Apr 2027	21.8	$2,065	$1,857	$1,526	$1,108
May 2027	26.5	$2,516	$2,290	$1,906	$1,474
Jun 2027	31.7	$3,006	$2,761	$2,318	$1,072
Jul 2027	37.2	$3,540	$3,273	$2,766	$1,506
Aug 2027	43.3	$4,121	$3,830	$3,254	$1,979
Sep 2027	49.9	$4,755	$4,438	$3,787	$2,495
12-month flows / Sep balance	49.9	$4,755	$22,321	$18,348	$9,664

Interpretation

First projected paid customers arrive in November. January 2027 is the first base-case operating-profitable month. June’s proposed contractor start lowers profit despite growing revenue. September gross margin is 85.3%; full-horizon gross margin is 82.2%. Gross profit includes fixed paid delivery infrastructure. October has negative gross profit because the proposed infrastructure budget starts before revenue.

Operating profit here excludes unpaid founder labor and unquantified taxes. The base model does not say Aftermath already has a profitable business. The positive forecast depends on acquiring and retaining customers at untested rates.

Founder-compensation comparison

The saved **Future founder salary** case pays $1,500/month from January through September (nine months: $13,500). It preserves base revenue and usage while reducing full-horizon operating profit from $9,664 to ($3,836). Monthly operating break-even first appears in July.

For a separate full-year compensation benchmark, $1,500 in every month would cost $18,000 and change the same base forecast to ($8,336) operating loss. This is arithmetic on the saved outputs, **not a new saved scenario or actual salary expense**. Neither salary illustration is fully loaded: employer obligations, benefits and the market value of all founder work still require confirmation.

Flows are totaled; account counts and MRR are September closing values, not sums. Rounded displayed rows may differ slightly from exact totals.

Cash, funding and an honest runway view

> **Opening cash is a confirmed $0 on 11 October 2026—not a September closing balance.** No financing or personal subsidy is booked. Negative forecast balances mean the proposed plan is unfunded; they are not actual overdrafts.

Month	Collections	Operating payments	Net cash flow	Unfunded ending cash
Oct 2026	$0	$950	($950)	($950)
Nov 2026	$141	$478	($337)	($1,287)
Dec 2026	$434	$524	($91)	($1,377)
Jan 2027	$749	$575	$175	($1,203)
Feb 2027	$1,090	$629	$461	($741)
Mar 2027	$1,458	$687	$772	$30
Apr 2027	$1,857	$749	$1,108	$1,139
May 2027	$2,290	$816	$1,474	$2,613
Jun 2027	$2,761	$1,689	$1,072	$3,685
Jul 2027	$3,273	$1,767	$1,506	$5,191
Aug 2027	$3,830	$1,852	$1,979	$7,169
Sep 2027	$4,438	$1,943	$2,495	$9,664
12-month flow / Sep ending	$22,321	$12,657	$9,664	$9,664

October is the remaining-month planning bucket after 11 October. To avoid understating funding, the saved plan conservatively schedules the entire proposed October monthly paid budget and $500 setup after that date. No earlier cash transactions or financial history are invented. Actual billing dates or deferred spending could change the cash need.

The base plan requires $950 proposed October payments and reaches its peak cumulative shortfall of $1,377 in December. Gross minimum financing to avoid negative cash under this model is that peak deficit. The planning target is **(peak deficit + $1,000 reserve) × 1.15 = $2,734**. With actual opening cash zero, the full target is an additional funding requirement.

Runway: $0 business cash cannot fund the proposed positive paid-spending plan. There is no financed paid-plan runway to claim. This does not establish when the free-tier MVP stops operating; that needs actual invoices, credit expiry, provider limits and who covers bills. The proposed $1,000 reserve is already unmet on 11 October.

The base cumulative operating cash change turns positive in March, but only after financing the early deficit; future modeled receipts cannot pay earlier bills retroactively. Conditional funding options are explicit founder funding, paid pilot prepayments, a confirmed grant or deferred paid deployment. None is assumed received or committed.

The January salary alternative needs $7,262 with the same reserve/contingency approach. All targets exclude unconfirmed tax/FX liabilities and remain conditional on the paid-cost and sales assumptions.

Conservative, base and upside cases

All three cases preserve $0 current founder cash pay, zero opening customers, no funding and the same $49/$199/$599 pricing hypotheses. They are alternative operating assumptions—not confidence intervals or observed performance.

Scenario	Annual revenue	Sep MRR	Annual op. profit/(loss)	Peak deficit	Cash target[1]
Conservative	$3,663	$749	($2,466)	$2,466	$3,986
Base	$22,321	$4,755	$9,664	$1,377	$2,734
Upside	$86,979	$20,341	$56,035	$1,423	$2,787

Driver	Conservative	Base	Upside
Opening qualified prospects/month	10	20	40
Monthly prospect growth	5%	10%	12%
Paid conversion / sales lag	10% / 2 months	15% / 1 month	20% / 1 month
New account mix: Starter / Growth / Enterprise	85% / 15% / 0%	70% / 30% / 0%	55% / 40% / 5%
Monthly churn: Starter / Growth / Enterprise	5% / 4% / 2%	3% / 2% / 1%	2% / 1.5% / 1%
Initial acquisition spend / monthly growth	$100 / 0%	$200 / 5%	$400 / 8%
Support hours per account: S / G / E	0.25 / 0.75 / 3	0.15 / 0.5 / 2	0.15 / 0.5 / 2
AI retry/context multiplier	2.0×	1.5×	1.5×
Contractor start / monthly cost	Sep 2027 / $800	Jun 2027 / $800	Apr 2027 / $1,500

Before April, upside Enterprise mix is redirected to Growth. Base and conservative have no Enterprise additions. September expected customer populations are 10.4, 49.9 and 154.4, respectively.

First operating break-even is June 2027 in conservative, January 2027 in base, and December 2026 in upside. **Conservative is not sustainably profitable:** it still loses $2,466 over the horizon and returns to a September monthly loss when the proposed contractor starts. The upside cash target is slightly higher than base despite stronger annual profits because it spends more before receipts arrive.

[1] Cash targets include the same proposed $1,000 reserve and 15% contingency. They fund the maximum deficit rather than the final result. The separate Future founder salary case is a compensation alternative to base, not a replacement for these demand scenarios.

Agent unit economics and sensitivity

Saved inference formula: [(20,000 × $3 + 2,000 × $15) / 1,000,000] × 1.5 = **$0.135 per investigation**. The multiplier budgets retries/context overhead across the workflow; actual billed calls and tool use must be measured. No caching discount or gateway markup is assumed.

Plan	AI/account/month	Support	Variable infra	Collection fee	Contribution
Starter	$0.27	$3.75	$1.00	$1.47	$42.51
Growth	$1.35	$12.50	$4.00	$5.97	$175.18
Enterprise	$5.40	$50.00	$12.00	$17.97	$513.63

Workload stress: one Growth account

One-at-a-time / combined stress	Investigations	Cost/invest.	Monthly AI	Contribution
Saved workload	10	$0.135	$1.35	$175.18
5× investigation volume	50	$0.135	$6.75	$169.78
2× input and output tokens	10	$0.270	$2.70	$173.83
Retry/context rises to 3×	10	$0.270	$2.70	$173.83
5× volume + 2× tokens + 3× retry	50	$0.540	$27.00	$149.53
Heavy context: 5× volume + 5× tokens + 3× retry	50	$1.350	$67.50	$109.03

Volume stress increases the modeled missing-entitlement rate from 0.2% to 1% at fixed monitored transactions. Token stress scales both input and output. At 5× incident volume, 2× tokens and a 3× retry multiplier, inference is 20× the saved budget. At unchanged customer populations, annual base inference cost rises from $141.23 to $2,824.68 and operating profit falls to $6,981. This stress excludes any associated extra support and infrastructure, so it is not a worst-case bound.

Paid conversion stress: same base pipeline and costs

Conversion	Sep accounts	Year revenue	Sep MRR	Year op. result	Cash target
10%	33.3	$14,881	$3,170	$3,148	$2,977
15%	49.9	$22,321	$4,755	$9,664	$2,734
20%	66.6	$29,762	$6,340	$16,180	$2,582

Sensitivity rows are transparent calculations from saved forecasts, not new model scenarios or market evidence. Conversion scales additions and customer populations from a zero opening population; churn, prices, plan mix, sales lag and fixed spending stay unchanged. A 0% conversion produces no subscription revenue.

September base cash CAC is $43.96 and contribution payback 0.53 months, but unpaid founder time is excluded. The salary case raises loaded cash CAC to $140.35 and payback to 1.68 months. Churn-based LTV remains speculative; do not justify paid scaling with it before renewals exist.

First 90 days: earn customer evidence

11 October 2026–8 January 2027. The targets below are proposed validation goals, not completed activity or revisions to the saved forecast. Founder-led execution, narrowly scoped pilots and recorded evidence matter more than paid reach.

Days 1–30 · Discover the operational pain

- Target 15 structured interviews with Paystack SaaS operators using warm introductions and direct founder outreach. Document last real incident, frequency, handling time, who authorizes repair and what a mistake would cost.
- Seek 3 design-partner agreements for a controlled pilot. Require an actual payment/entitlement workflow, least-privilege access, explicit recovery authorization, privacy boundaries and manual escalation.
- Instrument token usage, retry counts, support minutes and free-credit expiry. Test $49 and $199 willingness to pay with an explicit paid offer, not a survey alone.
- Keep the MVP on supported free resources while confirming bills and funding. The saved October paid budget is $950, unfunded; do not incur it merely because it appears in a spreadsheet.

Days 31–60 · Pilot before promising automation

- Use shadow mode and injected failures in consenting integrations; move to limited authorized recovery only after evidence and deterministic checks are exercised. Keep a manual rollback/escalation path.
- Target at least 5 qualified pilot evaluations across discovery and outreach, and seek the first genuine paid subscription. The model assumes 3 new accounts in November; actual performance must be reported separately.
- Measure paid confirmation, recovery correctness, time to access, false positives, manual exceptions, investigation tokens and support effort per account. No production reliability guarantee is inferred from a small sample.
- Publish only consented, factual case studies; do not count restored purchase value as revenue or assert prevented churn without measurement.

Days 61–90 · Test renewal and readiness to repeat

- Proposed gate: 3 genuinely paying customers, with at least 2 completing a first renewal, plus a defensible cost record for every paid account. These are minimum learning targets, not a substitute for the model’s expected December population of 6.2.
- Review allowance fit, measured support effort, price objections and retention. Explain any miss versus the forecast; revise assumptions transparently rather than inventing pipeline.
- Seek pilot prepayment or explicit funding only with clearly scoped service and fulfillment obligations. Book nothing as received until confirmed.
- Decide whether to continue, change customer segment/pricing or postpone commercial spending. Do not hire solely because June appears as an assumed start month.

Acquisition spending discipline

The base budget proposes $200 / $210 / $220.50 in October–December, conditional on funding. Start with direct outreach and credible demos; no audience, channel conversion or repeatable CAC has been validated. Paid spend earns expansion only when operators accept the offer, pay and renew.

Risks and spending gates

Principal risk	Financial consequence	Required evidence / control
Demand and sales assumptions fail	Revenue and funding targets become unreliable	Track qualified prospects, paid conversion, sales lag and renewals weekly; compare actuals with assumptions.
Unbounded investigation or false recovery	Inference spikes, support burden and potential liability	Independent payment evidence; deterministic authorization; least privilege, idempotency, token/retry/time budgets, audit and escalation.
Support exceeds modeled workload	Low-priced plans lose contribution	Measure minutes/account; revise scope and allowances before selling broad guarantees.
Free tiers/credits expire or rates rise	Cash cost arrives before receipts	Record expiry, spend ceilings and actual invoices; obtain funding or defer commitments.
Unpaid founder work hides true economics	Profitability and acquisition payback look overstated	Keep unpaid case separate from salary case; evaluate full-year compensation and future employer costs.
Nigeria legal, tax and FX status unresolved	Unbudgeted liabilities or payment friction	Confirm incorporation, tax registration and applicable obligations with local advice before scaling.
Enterprise obligations are premature	Security, integration and SLA costs exceed $599	Negotiate scope and support only after readiness; no enterprise commitment in base.

Milestones that justify higher spending

- **Start the paid operating budget:** an identified, confirmed funding source or customer receipts covering the near-term budget; no expenditure based on hypothetical future receipts. Base target $2,734 includes buffer, not a committed raise.
- **Increase acquisition spend:** proposed minimum 3 paying customers, 2 first renewals, measured account contribution positive after actual support/inference, and clear records of founder time. Small-sample CAC is a learning signal, not a stable benchmark.
- **Add engineering capacity:** a documented backlog paid customers need, safe-recovery evidence, and cash coverage for at least three months of the proposed contractor commitment without breaching the reserve. June is an assumption, not authorization.
- **Offer Enterprise / expand providers:** paid customer demand, reviewed security/privacy and recovery controls, measured integration/support workload and agreed usage-based scope. April appears only in upside; readiness governs actual launch.
- **Start founder salary:** confirmed affordable receipts or financing, updated compensation/tax costs and reserve coverage. January 2027 in the saved salary case is illustrative, not promised.

The decision

Aftermath has a specific, demonstrated technical workflow and a plausible customer problem. It does not yet have proven demand or an established fully compensated business. The disciplined next step is to buy evidence cheaply: narrowly scoped paid pilots, bounded autonomous execution, measured costs and renewals. Scale commitments only when that evidence and cash exist.

Sources, reconciliation and limitations

What this submission preserves

The existing cfo.ai model, $49/$199/$599 pricing hypotheses, conservative/base/upside scenarios and October 2026–September 2027 horizon are preserved. The separate saved future-founder-salary case is disclosed, not substituted for base. No financial history, customers, sales, funding or commercial partnerships were added.

Evidence provenance

- **Founder-provided facts:** company/product description; functional deployed MVP; Paystack test-mode demonstration; Claude Sonnet 4.6 investigation; payment verification; deterministic authorization and successful recovery. These claims are founder-reported, not independently audited by this business plan.
- **Confirmed financial facts:** zero customers and MRR, no commercial sales or external funding, $0 business cash on 11 October 2026, $0 current founder pay, Nigeria. Tax obligations and incorporation are unconfirmed.
- **Saved model:** customer movements and subscription revenue; monthly costs and unit economics; monthly cash requirements and checks; scenario summary; subscription/usage assumptions; business controls; confirmed facts and future salary inputs.
- **External rate basis:** Anthropic pricing documentation, Claude Sonnet 4.6: $3 per million input tokens, $15 per million output tokens. platform.claude.com/docs/en/about-claude/pricing. Actual gateway terms may differ.
- **Proposals added only in this document:** pilot usage-limit packaging, 90-day validation targets and spending gates. They do not change saved forecasts or constitute confirmed commitments.

Checks performed

Figures were read from a consistent saved-model snapshot on 11 October 2026. The twelve monthly revenue values total the saved annual revenue; monthly operating results total the saved annual operating result. Each month’s gross profit equals revenue less cost of delivery; operating result equals gross profit less operating expenses; cash flow equals collections less payments. Customer movement, allocation, cash and profit checks reconcile within numerical rounding.

The sensitivity arithmetic retains saved prices, costs and customer mechanics, varying only the explicitly stated driver. Rounding is for display only; annual totals use exact underlying values. MRR and account counts are closing balances, never summed across months. Negative unfunded cash is a financing requirement, not evidence of a real overdraft.

Scope boundaries

No independently quantified TAM, paid pipeline, production reliability benchmark, actual bill history or validated churn/LTV is available. The model excludes unquantified tax, FX, employer benefits, capex, debt, annual billing, credit losses and legal liabilities. It is a pre-tax operating-and-cash planning model, not audited financial statements. Predicted profits are conditional, not commercial validation.

> **Judging takeaway:** evaluate the technical recovery workflow as demonstrated evidence; evaluate commercialization, pricing, customer acquisition and profitability as explicit hypotheses to be tested. The financial plan shows what those hypotheses imply—and what cash and proof must precede spending.